ENG518

Mid-Term

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

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1. **Types of Research**:
    - Basic, Applied, Exploratory, Confirmatory, Quantitative, Qualitative.
2. **Three Continua**:
    - (a) Basic–Applied, (b) Qualitative–Quantitative, (c) Exploratory–Confirmatory.
3. **Research Design – 3 Components**:
    - Research questions, population/sample, and research design plan.
4. **Criteria for Evaluating a Research Proposal**:
    - Problem statement, literature review, hypothesis, method, significance, and time plan.
5. **Characteristics of True Research**:
    - Based on data, controlled, empirical, systematic, logical.
6. **Systematic Inquiry**:
    - Logical, planned investigation with defined methods to answer research questions.

7. **Good Sampling Characteristics**:
    - Free from bias, representative, economical, practical, accurate, and large enough.
8. **Sample Size – How to Know**:
    - Typically 10–20% of population or minimum 30 in each group; depends on design & precision.
9. **Sampling Reliability & Measurement**:
    - Measured using reliability coefficients (e.g., correlation). Consistency across samples/raters is key.
10. **External Validity**:

- Generalizability of results to other populations, settings, and times.

11. **Internal Validity**:

- Whether the changes in dependent variable are solely due to independent variables (i.e., causal accuracy).

12. **Limitations in Sampling**:

- Small size, selection bias, lack of representativeness, resource constraints.

13. **3 Limitations in Sampling**:

- Random error, systematic error, measurement error.

14. **Types of Variables**:
    - Independent, Dependent, Control, Moderator, Intervening.
15. **Five Examples of Variables**:
    - Age, gender, motivation, test scores, language exposure.
16. **Characteristics of Hypothesis**:
    - Testable, clear, consistent with facts, specific, allows deductions.
17. **Importance of Hypothesis (3 Lines)**:
    - Provides direction, links concepts, and offers testable solutions.
18. **Null Hypothesis**:
    - Asserts no relationship exists between variables.
19. **Control Group Hypothesis / Rivalry**:
    - Group tries to outperform due to awareness of being in control group (John Henry Effect).
20. **History & Maturation as Extraneous Factors**:
    - External variables affecting validity due to time and participant development.
21. **Types of Data Gathering**:
    - Observational, Instrumental, Interviews, Questionnaires.
22. **Observational Data Collection**:
    - Includes participant/non-participant observation, judges, introspection.
23. **Instrumental Data Collection Tools**:
    - Tests, questionnaires (open/closed), Likert scales, surveys.

24. **Three Attributes of Data**:
    - Validity, reliability, accuracy.
25. **Two Ways of Data Collection**:
    - Primary (e.g., interviews, surveys), Secondary (e.g., articles, books).
26. **Primary Data Sources**:
    - Observations, interviews, tests, case studies, direct fieldwork.
27. **Secondary Data Sources (5)**:
    - Books, journals, newspapers, online databases, previous theses.
28. **Numerical & Verbal Data Presentation**:
    - Tables, graphs (numerical); quotes, summaries (verbal).
29. **Five Verbal & Qualitative Tools**:
    - Interviews, open-ended questions, narratives, ethnographies, focus groups.
30. **First Two Steps in Data Collection**:
    - Decide procedure based on research design; select tool (observation, test, etc.).
31. **Good Problem Statement Criteria**:
    - Specific, empirically testable, focuses on variables.
32. **Statement of the Problem**:
    - Describes the issue to be addressed; basis for the study's purpose.
33. **Sources to Identify Research Problems**:
    - Literature reviews, gaps in existing research, real-world issues.
34. **Circular Reasoning**:

- A fallacy where the conclusion is assumed in the premise.

35.**Three Myths About Research**:

- Research is only for experts, always involves labs, always gives correct results.

36.**Three Characteristics of Reflective Thinking**:

- Self-evaluation, questioning assumptions, connecting theory to practice.

37.**Two Characteristics of "What" Questions**:

- Descriptive, exploratory, not hypothesis-confirming.

38.**Characteristics of Observational Procedure**:

- Structured/unstructured, participant/non-participant, visual/log-based.

39.**Characteristics of Population (Any 5)**:

40.**Five Considerations in Applied Linguistics**:

- Context, learner differences, language use, transferability, social factors.

41.**Limitations in ELT**:

- Contextual variance, lack of standardized assessment, cultural bias.

42.**Five ELT Journals**:

- TESOL, AAAL, IATEFL, AERA, ESP Journal.

43.**ELT in Research**:

- Focuses on classroom practice, learner identity, language skills, testing, materials.

44.**Primary Research Goal**:

- To explore and analyze firsthand experiences and generate original findings.

45. **Types of Research**

- **Basic Research**: Theoretical, broad studies aiming to add knowledge.
- **Applied Research**: Practical, problem-solving in real-life situations.
- **Exploratory Research**: Investigates unknown aspects.
- **Confirmatory Research**: Verifies known theories.
- **Qualitative vs. Quantitative**: Subjective (verbal data) vs. objective (numerical data).

46. **Characteristics of Good Sampling**

- Free from bias
- Objective and accurate
- Comprehensive and economical
- Approachable and practical
- True representation of the population
- Maintains sample size appropriately.

47. **Criteria of a Good Problem Statement**

- Clearly defined and specific
- Concerned with relevant variables
- Amenable to empirical testing.

48. **Five Differences: Qualitative vs Quantitative Research**

Feature	Qualitative	Quantitative
Data Type	Verbal/Descriptive	Numerical/Statistical
Research Design	Flexible, evolving	Structured, fixed
Focus	Understanding meaning	Measuring variables
Sample Type	Information-rich, small	Representative, large
Analysis	Thematic, interpretive	Statistical, objective
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49. **Control Group Rivalry (John Henry Effect)**

- When a control group, aware of its role, tries to outperform the experimental group.
- Undermines experimental integrity by introducing competition and bias.

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Maha Malik's Compilation